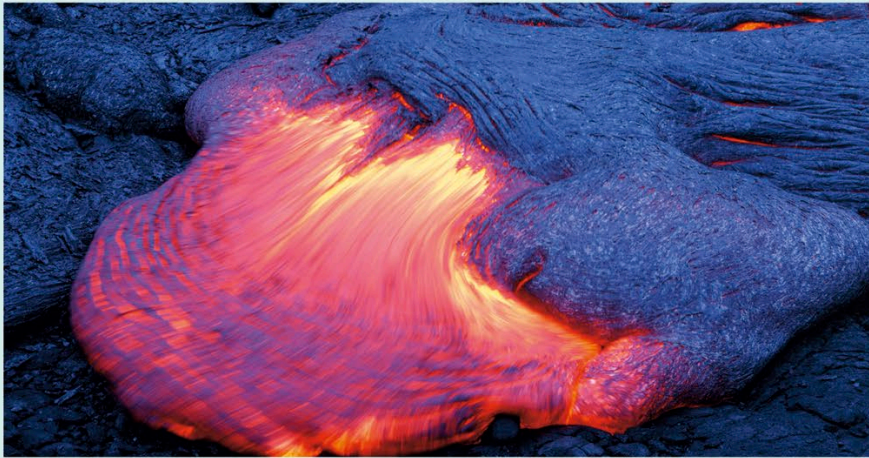
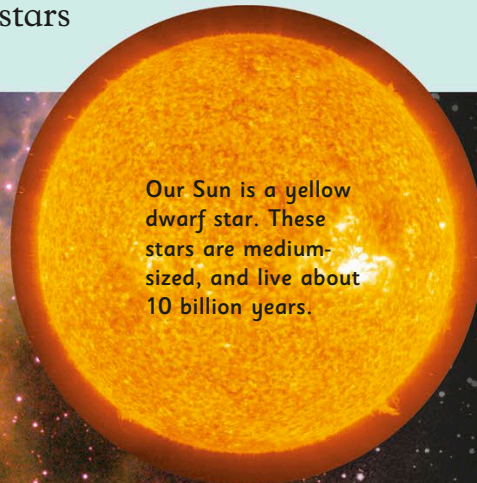




Is that one red?

Some stars shine red, others shine yellow or bluish white. A star's colour depends on its temperature. Red stars are the coolest, while blue stars are the hottest.

Lava also reveals its temperature through its colour. Here, the yellow lava is hotter than the red.

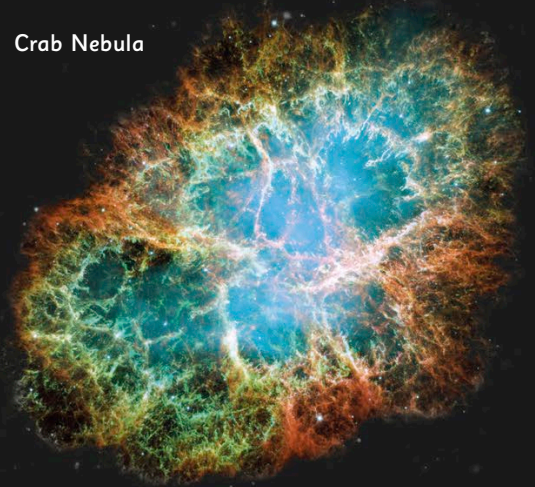


Our Sun is a yellow dwarf star. These stars are medium-sized, and live about 10 billion years.

What's in a name?

Horsehead, Lagoon, Eagle, and Crab... some of the best-known nebulae have popular names inspired by their shape.

Crab Nebula

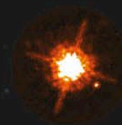


What type of star?

Stars have different characteristics according to the amount of matter involved in their birth. They differ in colour, temperature, and brightness, and in the length of time they stay alive.

The life of a star

The Universe is home to lots of different types of star.



Red dwarfs are made of less material than our Sun. They are cooler, dimmer, and live longer.



Blue giants are among the hottest stars, and live for less than 100 million years.



Supergiants are the rarest stars. They have short lives – under 50 million years.